

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1409

By Farmer

A RESOLUTION to pay tribute to the memory of Elaine Carver and her exemplary career as an educator.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we pay respectful tribute to the memory of an outstanding teacher who devoted her career to providing the highest quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Elaine Carver was one such estimable educator, who distinguished herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity for more than fifty-two years; she was still teaching at the time of her passing in November 2025; and

WHEREAS, born in Anahuac, Texas, Elaine Carver grew up in Newnan, Georgia, where she graduated from high school at the age of sixteen; she received her undergraduate degree from West Georgia College in 1973 and later earned a master's degree from Tusculum University; and

WHEREAS, an educator for fifty-two years, Elaine Carver began her illustrious teaching career in 1974 at Grantville Elementary School in Georgia; in 1985, she was employed as a teacher in Tennessee with Sevier County Schools, where she first taught at Wearwood Elementary School before moving two years later to New Center Elementary School, where she would spend the next thirty-eight years; and

WHEREAS, Elaine Carver was an extremely talented and compassionate professional who worked assiduously throughout her career in education to motivate her students, fellow teachers, and staff to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Carver served as an inspiration to the faculty and staff at New Center Elementary School, and her friendship and counsel were highly valued by those who were fortunate to know her; and

WHEREAS, a beloved wife, mother, and grandmother, she was joined in holy matrimony with her devoted husband, Ernie "Big E" Carver in 1974; their joyous union was blessed with two wonderful children, Allison Cunningham and Clay Carver, and three treasured grandchildren, Colby Cunningham, Cassi Carver, and Eli Cunningham; and

WHEREAS, a woman of deep and abiding faith, she was an active member of Lighthouse Baptist Church where she served as the pianist; and

WHEREAS, Elaine Carver epitomized the dedicated educator who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and her distinguished teaching career should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Elaine Carver, as we pay tribute to her exceptional service to the children of Tennessee as an educator for fifty-two years, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family, friends, and former students of Mrs. Carver.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.